

As illustrated in the earlier batch file, scripting languages need not work from scratch for application development as opposed to programming languages that are more suited for dictating algorithms and procedures. A script assumes that useful components are already present in some other language and it has to plug together the components. The IoT, artificial intelligence, machine learning and robotics are spilling new interdisciplinary areas.

Automation snooping into commerce and entertainment is providing better customer experience, which otherwise would be a very tedious task. As quoted by Thomas Devenport and Julia Kirby from 'Beyond Automation', *Harvard Business Review*, June 2015 issue, automation is seen as a concern to human jobs because of the path travelled in the three eras, discussed next.

Three eras of automation

If this wave of automation seems scarier than previous ones, it is for good reason. As machines encroach on decision making, it is hard to see the higher ground to which humans might move.

Era One: 19th century. Machines take away the dirty and dangerous—industrial equipment, from looms to cotton gin, relieves humans of onerous manual labour.

Era Two: 20th century. Machines take away the dull—automated interfaces, from airline kiosks to call centres, relieve humans of routine service transactions and clerical chores.

Era Three: 21st century. Machines take away decisions—intelligent systems, from airfare pricing to IBM's Watson, make better choices than humans, more reliably and faster.

Machines/computers have evolved from doing jobs hazardous to humans (waste management and hostile environment works) to jobs that require decision making (flight ticket booking and weather predictions). Humans are forced to step up and embrace technology. Automation can be viewed as an aide to humans rather than as competition.

As mentioned by Stifelsen for industriell og teknisk forskning (SINTEF), May 2013, 90 per cent of the world's data was generated in the preceding two years. Actively or passively, everyone is feeding data to the Internet. To produce meaningful conclusions and draw new schemes to benefit mankind is a herculean task. These tasks require cognitive ability held by humans.

Teaching the systems to work efficiently allows time for future researches in medicine, science and industry. For tech enthusiasts, this is the best time to learn and, for companies, the best time to invest in automation. **EFY**

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